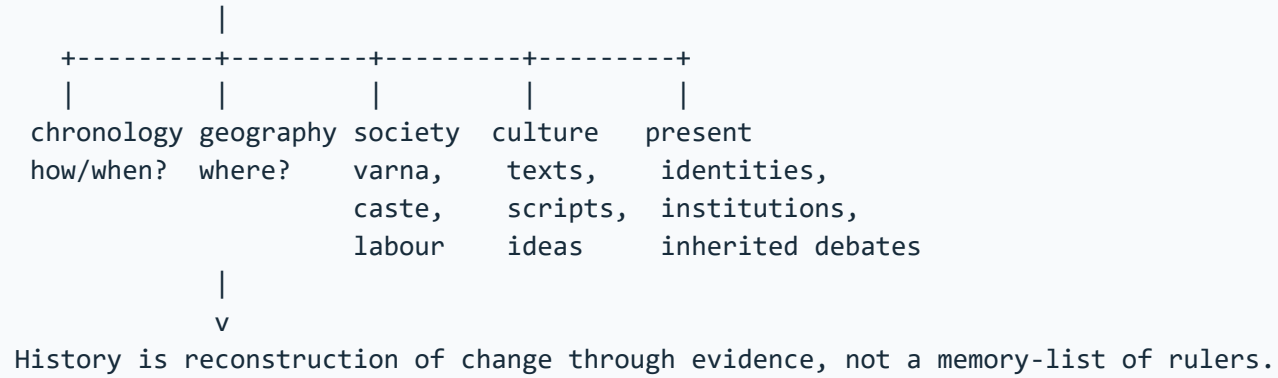


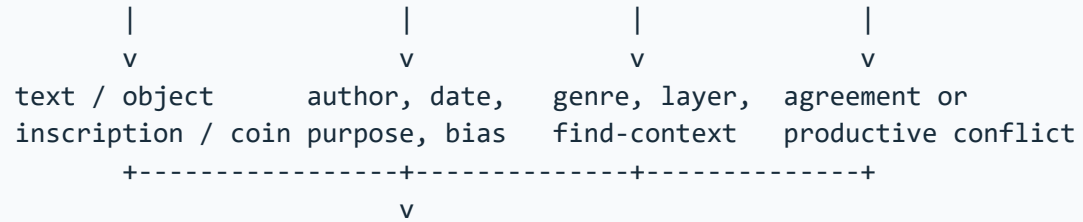
ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/9: Why ancient India matters: the complete inquiry

ANCIENT INDIA: WHY STUDY IT?



ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/9: From surviving trace to historical claim

SURVIVING TRACE → SOURCE CRITICISM → CONTEXT → CORROBORATION → HISTORICAL CLAIM



PROVISIONAL EXPLANATION WITH STATED LIMITS

Rule: absence of evidence may reflect preservation, excavation or elite silence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/9: Historiographical schools: claims and corrections

ORIENTALIST -> IMPERIAL/COLONIAL -> NATIONALIST -> MARXIST -> SOCIAL/SUBALTERN TURNS

texts and antiquity admired	despotism, stagnation, period labels	agency and unity, achievement	mode, class, surplus, production	gender, caste, tribe, labour, ecology, region
+-----+				
v				

No school is a neutral final word: compare question, evidence, category and silence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/9: Periodisation without communal boxes

PROBLEM: Hindu / Muslim / British labels make others religion the clock of history

|
v

RESPONSE: use overlapping processes, not sealed civilisational blocks

polity: lineage -> state -> empire -> regional formations

economy: foraging -> farming -> towns -> agrarian expansion

society: kinship -> varna ordering -> jati proliferation -> local negotiation

culture: oral/textual traditions + material practice + cross-regional exchange

VERDICT: dates organise; processes explain; regional change is asynchronous.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/9: Unity in diversity: a historical mechanism

ECOLOGICAL + LINGUISTIC + ETHNIC DIVERSITY



ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/9: Varna, caste and social history

NORMATIVE VARNA TEXTS prescribe ranked fourfold order

|

| must be tested against

v

INSCRIPTIONS + ARCHAEOLOGY + REGIONAL TEXTS + OCCUPATIONAL PRACTICE

|

v

HISTORICAL FIELD: jati, labour, gender, tribe, mobility, exclusion, patronage

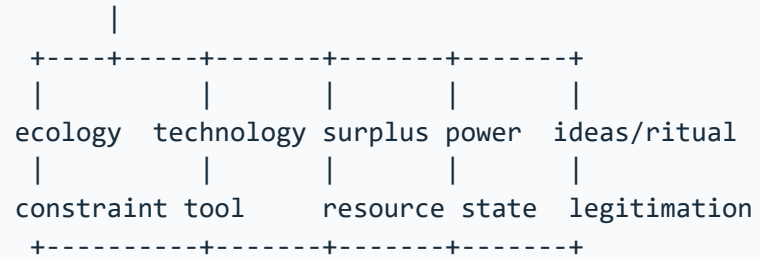
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v

Neither timeless rigidity nor automatic fluidity: institutions changed unevenly.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/9: Causation: explanation beyond great men

HISTORICAL CHANGE



|
v

Agency selects among conditions; no single factor mechanically determines outcome.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/9: Bias, silence and ethical reconstruction

ARCHIVE OVER-REPRESENTS: rulers | donors | literate elites | durable materials

ARCHIVE UNDER-REPRESENTS: women | labourers | forest groups | oral communities

|

v

CHECK: who produced it? for whom? what genre? what was unlikely to survive?

|

+-----+-----+

|

read statement critically

|

read silence cautiously

+-----+-----+

v

VERDICT: recover plurality without inventing voices the evidence cannot supply.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/9: Historiography answer architecture: 10/15/20 marks

10 MARKS: define historiography → name 2 schools → one evidence contrast → verdict

15 MARKS: frame issue → colonial claim → nationalist reply → material/social turn
→ source example → limitation of each → balanced judgement

20 MARKS: question/category → school timeline → evidence architecture → neglected
groups/regions → periodisation dispute → present stakes → synthesis

MUST NAME: source, historian/school, explanatory gain, residual blind spot.

CLOSE: ancient history is plural, evidence-led reconstruction, not usable myth.